

ZEINA HARES

Melbourne, VIC | (+61) 451 997 965 | zeinahares@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/zeinahares | github.com/zeinahares | zeinahares.github.io/Portfolio

SUMMARY

Final-year Bachelor of Science (Computing and Software Systems) student at the University of Melbourne, with a Certificate in Full Stack Web Development (96.52%) from the University of Sydney. Skilled in full-stack development (MERN stack), object-oriented design, and AI search algorithms, with 4+ years of hands-on experience designing and automating operational systems. Seeking graduate and internship opportunities in software engineering and computer science.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science — Computing and Software Systems Feb 2023 – Present
The University of Melbourne, Melbourne VIC

Certificate — Full Stack Web Development Feb 2023 – Jul 2023
University of Sydney | Grade: 96.52%

Bachelor of Media — Screen and Sound Production Jan 2016 – Dec 2020
University of New South Wales, Sydney NSW | WAM: 71.73

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, C, JavaScript (ES6+), Python, HTML5, CSS3, SQL, NoSQL, GraphQL, Haskell, Prolog, MIPS
Frameworks & Libraries: React, Node.js, Express, MongoDB, MySQL, Handlebars, jQuery, Bootstrap
Tools & Platforms: Git, GitHub, Heroku, npm, REST APIs, PWA, MVC, OOP, ORM, MERN Stack, Microsoft Excel (advanced), Google Workspace, DanceBiz

PROJECTS

Qwizard — Full Stack Quiz Platform
React, GraphQL, Mongoose, Express, Node.js, MERN Stack

- Led full-stack development of a quiz creation and sharing platform, serving as conceptual, project manager, and backend lead.
- Built and integrated a GraphQL API with Mongoose data models for quiz, user, and score management.
- Coordinated a multi-developer team through the full software development lifecycle from concept to deployment.

Pawesome Care — Pet Owner Social Platform
JavaScript, Handlebars, MySQL, Express, Node.js, MVC

- Directed project delivery and led development of the Blogs feature end-to-end, including MVC architecture, data modelling, and front-end design.
- Built and integrated a MySQL relational database schema to support multi-user pet profiles and community posts.

CineFile — Movie Discovery App
JavaScript, jQuery, OMDb API, OOP

- Conceptualised and built a movie discovery web app with access to over 1 million titles via third-party API integration.
- Engineered watchlist persistence and search functionality using object-oriented JavaScript design patterns.

Tetris Refactor — Object-Oriented Java Redesign
Java, OOP, UML

- Collaboratively refactored and redesigned a Tetris game in Java as part of a 3-person team, applying OOP principles to restructure the codebase for clarity and extensibility; drove the majority of system design decisions and produced the core UML diagrams documenting class structure and relationships.

AI Pathfinding — A* Search for Optimal Play Sequences

Python, A Search, Artificial Intelligence | Score: 7/8*

- Developed an A* search algorithm to determine optimal play sequences, applying heuristic design and state-space search techniques to achieve near-perfect results (7/8).

EXPERIENCE

Studio Operations Manager

Apr 2021 – Present

Musical Makers Club (MMC) — NSW & Remote | Casual

- Sole operations manager for a youth musical theatre company with nearly 200 enrolled students — responsible for all non-teaching functions including scheduling, venue bookings, enrolments, advertising, complaints resolution, client communications, and staff training.
- Restructured the company's DanceBiz database end-to-end, redefining data storage architecture and redesigning the invoicing system to automate invoice population — eliminating the need for manual invoice edits entirely.
- Overhauled the entire Google Drive structure and digitised the enrolments process — replacing ad-hoc email tracking with a structured Google Forms pipeline capturing payment plans, ticket numbers, sizing, and all event-specific data in a single submission.
- Rebuilt the company website from scratch and launched self-serve trial booking portals, reducing manual trial bookings from 100% to ~5% of total volume.
- Drove major improvements across key business metrics: doubled enquiry conversion rate (10% → 20%), nearly doubled trial booking rate (19% → 37%), increased trial attendance rate (71% → 94%), and reduced annual student attrition by 83% (75 → 13 students lost per year).
- Overhauled payment systems and structures, cutting bounced or unresolved payment incidents from 50–60 per year (requiring multiple follow-ups each) to fewer than 10 (resolved in 1–2 follow-ups).
- Transformed revenue and enrolment strategies — achieving 50%+ of show ticket sales within the first month of going live (previously majority in the final two weeks), and shifting once-off programmes from slow manual sign-ups to selling out within days of opening.
- Migrated community communications from Facebook to WhatsApp, centralising family engagement and enabling direct staff responses outside business hours.
- Introduced company-wide annual planning (minimum 6 months in advance) and redesigned all client-facing materials — including per-location yearly schedules, email templates, family handbooks, show programmes, and engagement strategies.
- Oversaw the full transition of business ownership — including training the incoming owner across all operational, financial, and administrative processes and handling technical transfers of domain ownership and associated platforms; served as the sole operational handler of all company events and communications during the owner's absence.
- Scripted automation to clean and standardise Facebook enquiry data using advanced Excel query logic — eliminating manual reformatting of phone numbers and enquiry dates on every entry and enabling consistent, error-free data import into company systems.
- Built and maintained a comprehensive business metrics system — tracking monthly KPIs (enquiries, trials booked/attended, enrolments, upgrades, and downgrades) and deriving yearly conversion ratios and retention rates; regularly interpreted and presented insights to ownership to inform strategic decisions.
- Established a formal incident reporting and resolution system; trained all teaching and administrative staff company-wide on new systems, tools, and processes.
- Handled daily client communication at scale — 3,000+ new enquiries across a two-month peak enrolment window, growing the client base twofold in 9 months.

Videographer, Photographer & Podcast Editor

Oct 2021 – Present

Josephine Lancuba — Remote | Freelance